

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT (PRD)

PRD Title	career coach.ai — PRD & Agile Backlog
Product	career coach.ai
Owner (PM)	Abhinav Kotar
Version	v1.0
Status	In Review
Created On	20-05-2026
Last Updated	24-05-2026

1. Product Objective

Career Coach.ai aims to eliminate the preparation gap between well-resourced and resource-constrained job seekers by delivering an AI-powered coaching system with persistent memory. The product's core objective is to provide every learner, regardless of budget or background, with the kind of personalised, longitudinal coaching that nowadays exists only through expensive human mentors. Each session builds on the last, creating a coaching loop that gets sharper the more it is used.

2. Problem and Goal

Dimension	Statement
Problem Being Solved	Aspiring professionals have no access to affordable, personalised career coaching that remembers their history. Every session with generic AI tools starts from zero, forcing users to repeat context and preventing them from tracking real improvement over time.
User Goal	To get job-ready faster by practising with a coach that knows their weak spots, gives structured actionable feedback, and shows their progress since their first session.
Business Goal	To build a sticky, daily-use product with high retention among bootcamp learners and career switchers, ultimately positioning career coach.ai as the go-to prep tool for outcome-focused programmes in India.
Product Goal	To ship a working MVP with a functional memory-driven coaching loop that does mock interviews, resume review, skill tracking, and session summaries further demonstrably improves user readiness by achieving a minimum 15% increase in the average aggregated competency score after four weeks of consistent use (at least 3 sessions/week).

3. User Stories

ID	User Story	Feature Area
US-00	<i>As a first-time user, I want to complete a quick onboarding flow where I define my target role, experience level, and perceived weak areas, so the first coaching session is immediately personalized.</i>	Initial Setup, Persistent Memory
US-01	<i>As a bootcamp learner preparing for PM interviews, I want to practise role-specific mock interview questions, so that I can build confidence and get structured feedback on each answer.</i>	Mock Interview, persistent memory
US-02	<i>As a returning user, I want the coach to remember my previous sessions and weak areas, so that I don't have to repeat context, and each session builds on the last.</i>	Persistent Memory
US-03	<i>As a career switcher with an engineering background, I want to upload my resume and receive role-aligned feedback, so that I can reposition my experience for product management roles.</i>	Resume Review
US-04	<i>As a learner who practises daily, I want to see a visual progress dashboard with my competency scores, so that I can track improvement over time and stay motivated.</i>	Progress Dashboard
US-05	<i>As a time-constrained user with only 20 minutes per day, I want a structured daily coaching session focused on my weakest skill, so that I make the most efficient use of my limited prep time.</i>	Daily Coaching Loop

4. Acceptance Criteria

US-01 — Mock Interview Module

- **Given** a logged-in user selects a PM behavioural interview session,
When they submit a text answer to the prompt,
Then the system must return structured feedback covering clarity, framework use, and a specific improvement tip within 15 seconds.
- **Given** the user completes a session,
When they view the session summary,
Then they must see a competency score for each dimension assessed and 2-3 prioritised action items.

The system must support at least three question types: PM behavioural, product sense, and estimation.

US-02 — Persistent Memory Store

- **Given** a user has completed at least one prior session,
When they start a new session,
Then the system must load their session history and pre-surface the lowest-scoring competency from prior sessions within the first prompt.
- **Given that** the user answers a question in an area previously marked weak,
When the session ends,
Then the memory store must update that competency's score and reflect the change in the dashboard within 60 seconds.

- Memory must persist across devices for the same authenticated user account.
- **Given** two authenticated users (User A and User B), **When** User A starts a new session, **Then** the system must only load session history and weak competency tags explicitly linked to User A's ID.

US-03 — Resume Review

- **Given** the user has uploaded a resume in PDF or DOCX format,
When they request feedback,
Then the system must generate role-aligned improvement suggestions covering language, positioning, and gap identification within 30 seconds.
- **Given** the system generates resume feedback,
When the user views it,
Then each suggestion must reference a specific section of their resume rather than generic advice.
- Uploaded resumes must not be stored beyond the active session unless the user explicitly opts in to storage.
- The system must provide clear messaging to the user if the resume parsing fails (e.g., due to file corruption or overly complex formatting) and suggest uploading a plain-text version.

5. Functional Requirements

Req ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-00	The system must require a user to complete a personalized profile setup (target role, experience level) immediately after registration to initialize the memory store.	P0
FR-01	Users must be able to register and log in using email/password or Google OAuth.	P0
FR-02	Users must be able to select a role (PM, SWE, Business Analyst) and interview type (behavioural, product sense, technical, estimation) before each session.	P0
FR-03	The system must generate role-specific interview questions dynamically using an LLM and evaluate user responses with structured feedback.	P0
FR-04	The system must persist session data, questions asked, answers given, and competency scores in a per-user memory store after every session.	P0
FR-05	Each new session must retrieve the user's prior session history and skill-gap tags to adapt question selection and difficulty.	P0
FR-06	Users must be able to upload a resume (PDF or DOCX, max 5MB) and receive role-aligned feedback with section-specific suggestions.	P1
FR-07	The system must display a skill radar/progress dashboard showing competency scores across tracked dimensions, updated after each session.	P1
FR-08	Each session must end with a structured summary: competency scores, 2-3 prioritised action items, and a comparison to the previous session.	P0
FR-09	The daily coaching loop must automatically identify the user's lowest-scoring competency and build a 20-minute focused session around it.	P1
FR-10	The system must support session history browsing so users can review any past session, answers, and feedback received.	P1

6. Non-Functional Requirements

Area	Requirement
Response Time	LLM-generated feedback must be returned within 15 seconds for interview responses and within 30 seconds for resume review under normal load.
Reliability	The platform must maintain 99.5% uptime during active usage windows. Session data must be auto-saved to prevent loss on disconnection.
Privacy	Resume files must not be retained beyond the active session unless the user explicitly opts in. Session data must be scoped to the authenticated user only.
Security	All data in transit must be encrypted via TLS 1.2+. User passwords must be hashed using bcrypt. OAuth tokens must be validated server-side.
Scalability	The system must support up to 1,000 concurrent users without degradation. The memory store architecture must support horizontal scaling.
Accessibility	The web interface must meet WCAG 2.1 AA standards. All interactive elements must be keyboard-navigable and screen-reader compatible.
Portability	The product must function correctly on Chrome, Firefox, and Safari on both desktop and mobile web without requiring native app installation.

7. Assumptions

- Users are comfortable interacting with text-based AI interfaces and do not require voice or video input for the MVP.
- Users are willing to share basic profile information (target role, experience level) to personalise their coaching sessions.
- The LLM provider (Claude / OpenAI) will maintain consistent API availability and response quality throughout the MVP phase.
- Bootcamp learners and early-career professionals have reliable internet access and use desktop or mobile web browsers regularly.
- The MVP user base will be small enough (under 500 active users) that a single vector store instance will handle memory retrieval without performance issues.
- Users will engage with the product at least 3-4 times per week during active job search periods, providing sufficient data for the memory store to be useful.

8. Dependencies

Dependency	Type	Details
LLM API	External	Claude API or OpenAI GPT-4o for core processing. Implement an LLM Abstraction Layer (or Gateway Service) to allow for quick switching between LLM providers and route high-volume, low-complexity tasks to cheaper tiers. Rate limits and costs must be monitored.
Vector Database	Infrastructure	Pinecone or ChromaDB for persisting user session embeddings and enabling memory retrieval at session start.

Auth Provider	External	Google OAuth 2.0 for social login. Supabase or Firebase Auth for email/password flows.
File Parsing	Internal / Library	PDF and DOCX parsing library (pypdf, python-docx) required for resume upload and text extraction before LLM processing.
Analytics	External	PostHog or Mixpanel for tracking session events, funnel completion, and retention metrics.
Engineering Support	Internal	Frontend (React), backend (FastAPI or Node), and DevOps support required for deployment and memory store integration.
Design Support	Internal	UI/UX design for the skill radar dashboard and session summary screens — the two highest-complexity surfaces in the MVP.

9. Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Category	Impact	Probability	Mitigation
LLM feedback quality is inconsistent or generic	AI / Technical	High	Medium	Use structured output prompting with evaluation rubrics; add human-reviewed example responses to the prompt context.
Users do not trust AI-generated coaching feedback	User	High	Medium	Show transparent reasoning behind scores; allow users to flag unhelpful feedback; include example 'good answer' benchmarks.
Memory retrieval adds noticeable latency to session start	Technical	Medium	Medium	Pre-fetch user context asynchronously on login rather than at session start; cache the last session summary.
Low retention after first 2-3 sessions	Product	High	High	Ship progress dashboard and streak tracking alongside core coaching features; send re-engagement nudges at the 48-hour inactivity mark.
Privacy concerns reduce willingness to upload resumes	User / Business	Medium	Medium	Clear consent messaging; session-only storage by default; explicit opt-in required for any persistent resume storage.
LLM API costs exceed budget at scale	Business	Medium	Low	Implement token budgets per session; cache repeated question-feedback pairs; monitor cost per session from day one.

10. Agile Backlog

Epic: Memory-Driven Interview Coaching

Build a complete interview coaching loop where users can practise mock interviews, receive structured feedback, and have their progress tracked across sessions via a persistent memory store forming the core differentiated experience of career coach.ai.

User Story	Description	Priority	Story Points	Notes
Mock Interview Module	As a learner, I want to practise role-specific mock interview questions and receive structured AI feedback so that I can improve with every session.	High	8	Covers PM behavioural, product sense, estimation question types. Core MVP feature.
Persistent Memory Store	As a returning user, I want the coach to remember my weak areas from prior sessions so that each new session builds on the last.	High	13	Requires vector DB setup, session embedding, and context injection into LLM prompt.

User Story	Description	Priority	Story Points	Notes
Session Summary & Action Items	As a user, I want a structured end-of-session summary with scores and next steps so that I know exactly what to work on before my next session.	High	5	Depends on FR-08. Should be generated automatically at session close.
Skill Radar / Progress Dashboard	As a learner, I want to see a visual radar of my competency scores so that I can track improvement over time and stay motivated.	High	8	Requires aggregated session data. Radar chart UI. Key retention driver.
Resume Review	As a career switcher, I want to upload my resume and get role-aligned feedback so that I can reposition my experience for PM roles.	Medium	5	Needs file upload, PDF/DOCX parsing, and structured LLM feedback prompt.
Daily Coaching Loop	As a time-constrained user, I want a focused 20-minute session on my weakest skill so that I make efficient use of my daily prep time.	Low	3	Depends on the memory store being live. Essentially a curated session trigger.